NOT BUILT FOR THIS

The ADHD Admin Scripts

12 word-for-word scripts for the phone calls, emails and forms you've been avoiding.

WHAT'S INSIDE

6

Phone Scripts

GP, dentist, subscriptions, refunds, utilities, voicemail

4

Email Scripts

Overdue replies, saying no, clarifying tasks, chasing invoices

2

Form Scripts

Cancellation fields, medical forms, admin overwhelm

By Sarah Kemp

notbuiltforthis.co

Plus: how to use them when your brain is offline

Read this first

This is a 4-minute read. After this, every script in this PDF can be lifted directly off the page and used.

Why scripts work for ADHD brains

If you're improvising under cognitive load, you will lose. Phone calls, emails to authority figures, and forms with judgement attached — these all spike your nervous system into threat mode. And once you're in threat mode, your prefrontal cortex (the part that does language, logic, and tact) goes quiet.
Scripts solve this by removing the cognitive load. You don't have to think. You read. The person on the other end never knows the difference. The dentist receptionist does not care that you're reading from a script. They care that you booked the appointment.

Every script in this PDF is built on three rules:

01

No softening

No 'sorry to bother you'. No 'I know you're busy'. ADHD brains can't afford the cognitive overhead of softening.

02

State the thing

Lead with what you need. Don't bury it. Get straight to the point.

03

End the call

When you've got what you need, stop talking. 'Thanks, bye' is a complete sentence.

How to use this PDF

Don't read it cover to cover. Find the script that matches the thing you've been avoiding. Copy it. Paste it into a notes app or print it. Read it word-for-word.
If your hands shake when you make the call — that's normal. Read the script anyway. The shake will fade by the third call.

BEFORE ANY SCRIPT

The 3-minute regulation protocol

Don't make the call cold. Your nervous system thinks the phone call is a tiger. You can't reason with a tiger. Discharge the threat first, then dial.

1

Cold water on your wrists

30 seconds. Run cold water over your wrists.

Triggers vagal nerve. Tells your body it's not in danger.

2

Six slow breaths

4 counts in, 6 counts out.

Long exhale activates parasympathetic nervous system.

3

Two minutes walking

Walk around the kitchen. Move your body.

Discharges the threat response your body wants to act on.

Then dial. The whole prep takes three minutes.

The call you couldn't make for six weeks now takes ninety seconds.

PHONE SCRIPTS

Script 1 Booking a GP appointment

Use it for: When your brain is shouting 'just call' and you've been not-calling for three weeks.

READ THIS WORD-FOR-WORD

"Hi, my name is [your name]. My date of birth is [DOB]. I need an appointment for [reason — keep it factual, e.g. 'a recurring headache for two weeks']. The earliest available works for me."

AFTER THE REQUEST

If they ask if it's urgent, answer yes/no. Don't elaborate. If they offer a date, accept it. Don't negotiate. End with 'Thanks, bye.'

Script 2 Booking a dentist appointment

Use it for: When you've been in pain for more than a week. Yes, more than a week.

READ THIS WORD-FOR-WORD

"Hi, my name is [your name]. I'd like to book a [check-up / appointment for pain]. The earliest available works for me. My last appointment was [if you remember — if not, say 'I'm not sure']. My address is [address]."

AFTER THE REQUEST

If they say 'we don't have anything for six weeks', accept it. Then ask: 'Could you put me on the cancellation list?' That's the magic phrase. Cancellations come up weekly. End with 'Thanks, bye.'

Script 3 Cancelling a subscription

Use it for: Sky, gym membership, magazine, streaming you forgot about.

READ THIS WORD-FOR-WORD

"Hi, my name is [your name]. My account number is [account number]. I'd like to cancel my [service name]. The reason is I no longer use it. The earliest cancellation date works for me."

AFTER THE REQUEST

They will try to retain you. This is their job. The exit script is: 'Thank you, but I've already decided. Please process the cancellation.' Repeat verbatim if needed. End with 'Thanks, bye.'

PHONE SCRIPTS (CONTINUED)

Script 4 Chasing a refund or money owed

Use it for: When something hasn't arrived and you've been told to 'check back in a few days' three times.

READ THIS WORD-FOR-WORD

"Hi, my name is [your name]. My account or reference number is [number]. I'm calling about a refund I was promised on [date]. It hasn't arrived. Can you check the status and give me a confirmed date."

AFTER THE REQUEST

If they can't give a date: 'I'd like to escalate this. Can you put me through to a manager.' Don't leave the call without either a date or an escalation. End with 'Thanks, bye.'

Script 5 Switching energy provider

Use it for: After you've signed up online but the new provider needs confirmation.

READ THIS WORD-FOR-WORD

"Hi, my name is [your name]. The address is [address]. I'm switching to [new provider name]. I'm calling to confirm the switch is in progress. Can you give me an expected switch date."

AFTER THE REQUEST

Write the switch date down. Add it to your calendar. The call is now over. End with 'Thanks, bye.'

Script 6 The voicemail script

Use it for: Call at lunch. Or 8am. Or 5pm Friday. Anytime they're unlikely to pick up.

READ THIS WORD-FOR-WORD

"Hi, this is [your name]. I'm calling about [the thing — one sentence]. The best way to reach me is by email at [email address]. My phone is [number] but email is best. Thanks."

AFTER THE REQUEST

If they ring back when you're regulated, pick up. If they ring back when you're not, let it go to voicemail. They will email. The ball is back in your court without a real-time interaction.

EMAIL SCRIPTS

Script 7 Replying to an overdue email

Use it for: When the email is six weeks old and you keep nearly replying and then not replying.

COPY THIS

Hi [name],
Apologies for the slow reply. To answer your question: [one-sentence answer].
If you need anything else, let me know.
Best,
[your name]

NOTES

Three rules. One: never explain why you didn't reply. They don't need it and the explanation makes it worse. Two: answer the actual question they asked. Don't volunteer more. Three: send it. The reply that goes out today beats the perfect reply that goes out never.

Script 8 Saying no to a meeting / call / favour

Use it for: When your nervous system is at 5% and you'd rather chew glass than do the thing.

COPY THIS

Hi [name],
Thanks for thinking of me. I'm not going to be able to [do the thing] right now — I'm protecting my bandwidth this month.
If it's not time-sensitive, happy to revisit in [a future month].
[Your name]

NOTES

Don't justify. Don't apologise twice. 'Protecting my bandwidth' is a complete reason. People accept it. The ones who don't are the people you needed to say no to anyway.

EMAIL SCRIPTS (CONTINUED)

Script 9 Asking your boss to clarify a task

Use it for: When you've read the brief four times and still don't know what they want.

COPY THIS

Hi [name],
Quick clarification on [project]: I want to make sure I'm focused on the right thing. My understanding is [your version in one sentence]. Is that the priority, or is there a piece I should be focusing on first?
Thanks,
[your name]

NOTES

This works because you're not saying 'I don't understand'. You're showing your work and asking them to confirm. Managers like this. Send it. The 30 seconds of vulnerability beats two days of misdirected work.

Script 10 Chasing an invoice / payment

Use it for: When polite reminders haven't worked.

COPY THIS

Hi [name],
Following up on invoice [number] dated [date], for [amount]. It's now [X days] overdue. Could you confirm by reply when this will be settled? If there's an issue with the invoice, let me know and I'll resolve it today.
Thanks,
[your name]

NOTES

Two notes. Don't say 'just chasing'. Don't apologise. The invoice is due. State the fact. End the email.

FORM SCRIPTS

Forms aren't scripted in the same way phone calls and emails are. But the part of forms that triggers ADHD shutdown is the open-ended 'tell us about yourself' or 'reason for application' fields. These are scripts for those.

Script 11 The 'reason for cancellation' field

Use it for: Subscriptions, services, memberships. They want a sob story. Don't give them one.

WRITE THIS

"I no longer require the service."

WHY IT WORKS

Six words. That's the whole answer. Don't write 'because money is tight' (they'll offer a discount). Don't write 'because I'm not using it' (they'll offer a free month). 'No longer require the service' is unanswerable.

Script 12 The 'anything else we should know?' field

Use it for: GP forms, insurance forms, employer forms. ADHD brains spiral here.

WRITE THIS

If the field is genuinely optional and not relevant:

Leave it blank.

If you feel you should fill it:

"Nothing further to add at this time."

WHY IT WORKS

Optional means optional. Blank is a complete answer. The form will submit. ADHD brains over-disclose because we want to be helpful. You don't owe a stranger your medical, financial or life history. Submit the form.

When you can't even start

Sometimes you've got the script and you still can't make the call. That's not the script's fault. That's a regulation problem. Try this six-step protocol:

1

Regulate

Three minutes. Cold water, breath, walk. Use the 3-minute protocol from earlier.

2

Name the task

Out loud. Say it. "I am calling the dentist to book a check-up."

3

Shrink the task

Not 'do my admin'. Just 'open the contacts app'. Make it tiny.

4

Choose one next step

Just one. Not a list. One single action you can do right now.

5

Use a script

From this PDF or one you've written. Read it word-for-word.

6

Stop before overwhelm

Set a 45-minute timer. When it goes, stop. Don't push through.

This is the system I built into the ADHD Admin Reset Session. We do all six steps together, with twenty other people on Zoom doing the same.

DOING THIS ALONE IS THE HARD PART

The honest bit

These scripts work. I've tested them on dentists, energy companies, HMRC, my landlord, my GP. They work because they remove cognitive load.

But here's the thing nobody talks about. Most ADHD adults don't fail because they don't have the right script. They fail because they're alone in the kitchen at 2pm trying to make the call and their nervous system is screaming and there's nobody there to say 'now do it'.

The script is necessary. It's not sufficient.

What actually works: body doubling

Body doubling is the science of co-regulation. When you're in the same space (physical or digital) as someone else who's regulated and doing the same kind of task, your nervous system can borrow theirs. The threat response shrinks. The prefrontal cortex comes back online. The script gets used.
I've done more admin in 90 minutes of body-doubled time than in 90 days alone. That's not a slogan. That's an honest measurement of what happened to me last month.

The ADHD Admin Reset Session

DATE	DURATION	CAPACITY
Saturday 11 July 2026	90 minutes online	20 spots

Body-doubled admin. We do these scripts together. Nervous system regulation, then the calls, then the close.

Join the Waitlist

Waitlist gets 24-hour early access and founder pricing. If these scripts helped, the session is the next step. No newsletter spam, just the occasional email when something useful drops.

ONE MORE TOOL FOR YOUR TOOLKIT

For the life admin you cannot face

Help for the piles you keep avoiding.

Doom Pile turns overwhelm into one clear next step across bills, body admin, cleaning, focus, sleep and more. Built for the moments when a task is small on paper but weirdly impossible in real life.

Bills | Clean | Body | Focus | Vent | Cook | Sleep

FREE

One try in every pile

Use each mode once before you decide.

FULL ACCESS

£9.99/year

Early supporter price.

WHY IT WORKS

You are not lazy. You are overloaded.

Built for the moments when a task is small on paper but weirdly impossible in real life.

Try Doom Pile Free

www.doompile.co.uk